
DOMINIONS 6 NATION DOSSIER

Middle Age Marignon

Fiery Justice

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Unmodded 6.36 doctrine with source-labelled rules, strategy, and open verification work.

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Middle Age Marignon: Fiery Justice

Marignon one-page command brief

Marignon begins as an armoured human kingdom backed by crossbows, sacred cavalry, cheap Fire apprentices, Astral-capable Witch Hunters, powerful priests, and a capital pipeline of Grand Masters. Its first transition is from ordinary steel into coordinated Fire and Astral battle magic. Its later transition is into angelic summons and stronger strategic magic.

The nation is strongest when it uses each layer for the job it actually performs:

- crossbows punish armour and force shields;
- cheap heavy infantry hold space and add siege bodies;
- Knights of the Chalice provide concentrated sacred force rather than affordable frontage;
- Witch Hunters turn ordinary forts into Fire-Astral war colleges;
- Grand Masters supply high paths, random Air or Earth access, and the best communion masters;
- Inquisitors and freely recruitable Friars turn dominion control into a campaign tool;
- Architects improve the fort network and shorten sieges;
- national angel rituals convert Conjuration research and Astral pearls into mobile sacred power.

The main limits are just as important. Marignon has no dependable native Water, Death, Nature, Blood, or Glamour. Its best mage is capital-only, expensive, and consumes four recruitment points. Much of the army wears enough armour to care about fatigue, armour destruction, and battlefield-wide elemental damage. A plan that only adds more heavy infantry eventually meets a counter it cannot out-armour.

Marignon evidence and ruleset

The roster and national rules below use the revision-2 official manual. Grand Master randoms are resolved through the pinned 6.35 Inspector export: F3 S2 H2, one guaranteed level from Fire, Air, Earth, or Astral, plus an independent 10% second level from the same set. Advice is labelled strategy. Exact expansion counts remain test dependent because map strength, independent composition, scales, bless, formations, and commander quality change the result.

Marignon conversion chain

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crossbows, armour, and sacred cavalry
-> safe expansion and defensible borders
-> forts, laboratories, and Architects
-> Witch Hunters at ordinary forts
-> Fire-Astral battlefield packages
-> Grand Master communions and boosters
-> angels, remote reach, and Throne operations
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The chain can break in three common places. Excess cavalry delays forts. Too many Initiates produce research without enough Astral organisers. Too many Grand Masters consume capital time and gold before the wider fort network can support them.

National rules that shape the plan

Rule	Practical consequence
Order limit +1	Marignon can lean further into Order when the economy and recruitment plan justify it.
Bless points +3	A useful sacred package does not require the Pretender to pay for every point alone.
Inquisition	Inquisitors remove enemy dominion and can spread friendly dominion up to one candle in owned provinces.
Friars outside forts	Priest coverage, preaching, and army leadership do not consume a fort commander slot everywhere.
Architects	The capital can produce commanders that build better forts and provide +15 siege strength.
Standard forts	The nation still needs a deliberate fort-and-laboratory budget; the Architect improves the result but does not pay for it.

Inquisition is not merely defensive flavour. It supports border conversion, weakens hostile dominion effects, and helps sacred forces operate under their own bless. It is still slower than winning the province and building infrastructure. Priests should support the campaign rather than replace it.

Marignon roster by job

Unit	Best job	Important limit
Crossbowman	Armour pressure, supporting fire, cheap ranged mass	Ordinary precision and friendly-fire risk; needs a screen
Pikeneer	Anti-large line and repel pressure	Low Defence and ordinary damage when the length advantage is irrelevant
Halberdier	Armour-piercing line damage and siege mass	Slow, heavily armoured, vulnerable to fatigue and missiles without shields
Swordsman	General heavy infantry and high-damage strikes	No shield and the same fatigue problem as the other heavy line troops
Man at Arms	Better-defended line and bodyguard-quality infantry	Higher gold, resources, and recruitment-point demand
Flagellant	Cheap sacred mass, patrol or siege body, disposable pressure	No armour, poor Defence, and losses can become expensive when the bless is overbuilt around them
Royal Guard	Durable non-sacred cavalry and mobile reserve	Very expensive in resources and recruitment points
Knight of the Chalice	Sacred shock cavalry and decisive flank	Seventy gold, heavy resource and recruitment demand, and a mount that remains a separate target

The ordinary expansion army should normally combine a protected line with crossbows. Pikes are selected when large targets justify them. Great weapons are selected when armour is the problem. Sacred cavalry is used where the charge and survivability change the battle enough to justify its price. Mixing every unit into every party hides which piece is doing useful work.

Marignon commander and mage portfolio

Commander	Paths or ability	Main jobs	Recruitment warning
Initiate	F1	Cheap research, light Fire support, site searching	Two recruitment points for a narrow mage; do not let cheap gold cost hide the fort-turn cost
Inquisitor	F1 H2, Inquisitor	Dominion work, blessing, banishment, leadership	Better at religious operations than research efficiency
Witch Hunter	F2 S1 H1, Patrol +10	Core researcher, communion member, Holy Pyre caster, patrol support	Costs 260 gold and two recruitment points; field losses damage both research and war capacity
High Inquisitor	F1 H3, Inquisitor	Strong preaching, large blessings, claims, banishment	Capital-only and four recruitment points
Grand Master	F3 S2 H2 plus FAES randoms	High research, communion master, boosters, angels, high Fire and Astral	Capital-only, 520 gold, four recruitment points
Architect	Mason, Siege +15	Better forts, siege acceleration	Capital commander turn competes directly with Grand Masters and High Inquisitors
Friar	H1, recruitable outside forts	Cheap priest coverage and ordinary leadership	Not a replacement for a battle mage
Assassin, Scout, Troubadour	Stealth operations	Information, commander pressure, deception	Outcomes are matchup dependent and can create diplomatic consequences

Reading the Grand Master random

The guaranteed random gives a nominal 25% result in Fire, Air, Earth, or Astral. The independent 10% second roll slightly raises the chance of seeing at least one chosen path to 26.875%. A double result in the same chosen path occurs only 0.625% of the time.

This produces several distinct assets:

- F4 reaches stronger Fire thresholds without a battlefield boost;
- S3 casts the first national angel ritual directly and improves Astral work;
- A1 opens Air searching and low-level utility, but it does not make Marignon a broad Air nation;
- E1 opens Earth searching and can begin an Earth booster or Summon Earthpower route;
- rare doubled results are bonuses, not requirements on which an opening should depend.

Every Grand Master should be labelled by random immediately. An unrecorded E1 or A1 roll can sit in a laboratory for years while the nation mistakenly plans around a path it believes it lacks.

Marignon opening priorities

The opening has four simultaneous jobs:

- 1 expand with a tested infantry, crossbow, sacred, or Pretender package;
- 2 preserve enough gold and resources for the next fort;
- 3 begin recruiting Witch Hunters wherever laboratories exist;
- 4 use the capital on the scarce asset actually needed: Grand Master, Architect, High Inquisitor, or sacred cavalry.

The default capital choice is not automatically a Grand Master every month. An early Architect can create better long-term fort geometry. A High Inquisitor may be necessary for a Throne or dominion emergency. The correct capital queue follows the national bottleneck.

Expansion packages to test

Package	Intended target	Failure signal
Armoured line plus crossbows	Ordinary infantry and armoured independents	Fast flankers reach the crossbows or missile fire causes unacceptable friendly loss
Pikes plus supporting fire	Large animals and cavalry	Small high-Defence troops ignore the length advantage and win the melee
Knight-led shock force	Weak lines and exposed ranged troops	Dense anti-large weapons, fatigue, or magic-resistant damage remove the expensive front
Awake Pretender plus minimal escort	Rapid tempo and difficult early provinces	The god is taking afflictions, being trapped, or delaying the economic design it was meant to enable

No fixed troop count is presented as universal. The useful range comes from replaying the actual local independent types under the chosen scales and bless.

Marignon research response tree

Trunk: make Witch Hunters operational

Thaumaturgy 1
-> Conjuraton 3
-> Evocation 4

- Thaumaturgy 1 opens Communion Master and Communion Slave.
- Conjuraton 3 supplies Power of the Spheres for Astral casters and Phoenix Power for Fire casters.
- Evocation 4 opens the national Holy Pyre: an F2 armour-piercing area spell with a large base area, available to every Witch Hunter.

This is a real first-war package because an ordinary fort can recruit the caster. It still needs range, formation, gem, fatigue, and friendly-fire checks before battle.

Branch A: heavier Fire and Astral fighting

Continue into Evocation 5 when Falling Fires, Stellar Cascades, or another current spell solves the observed enemy. Fire resistance can make a pure Fire branch poor. High-MR targets can reduce some Astral control packages. The army should carry at least two damage mechanisms rather than asking one school to defeat every defence.

Branch B: protect the mundane army

Alteration 3 gives S1 Witch Hunters Body Ethereal and other defensive tools. Construction 2 and 4 open practical equipment and Earth support when the right Grand Master exists. This branch is strongest when ordinary troops are still winning contact but need help surviving the enemy's damage.

Branch C: national angel ladder

Research	National ritual	Native route
Conjuration 5	Contact Angel of the Host, S3, 7 pearls	S3 Grand Master or an S2 caster with a named boost
Conjuration 6	Angelic Choir, S3, 15 pearls	Same S3 route; produces three H2 flying sacred mages
Conjuration 6	Contact Harbinger, S4, 25 pearls	Higher Astral access; supplies an A3 H2 flying commander
Conjuration 7	Heavenly Wrath, S3 F1, 35 pearls	S3 Grand Master already meets Fire
Conjuration 7	Angelic Host, S5, 50 pearls	Communion, boosters, or imported access
Conjuration 9	Heavenly Choir, S7 F2, 144 pearls	Endgame project, not an ordinary extension of the opening

Contact Angel of the Host is the first clean conversion point. It turns a reachable S3 Grand Master and seven pearls into a flying sacred combat body. Contact Harbinger is an access project as much as a summon: its A3 H2 path line can widen Air magic and support mobile operations.

Marignon battlefield packages

Holy Pyre battery

- protected infantry establishes contact;
- crossbows punish armour before and during contact;
- Witch Hunters cast Holy Pyre from safe range;
- an Astral package protects or controls the most important squares;
- a reserve handles fire-resistant or highly mobile targets.

The spell is national, but the formation is not automatic. Large area can punish friendly troops if the battle line collapses into the target zone.

Small communion

Use a small communion only when the path gain creates a named spell package. Count every master cast and every slave's relative path. Witch Hunters are expensive enough that disposable-slave doctrine can lose the research war even after winning one battle. Book V owns the fatigue and collapse arithmetic.

Angel-supported mobile force

Flying angels solve movement and target-access problems that ordinary heavy infantry cannot. They still need intelligence, retreat routes, and enough conventional mass to hold what they take. A seven-pearl Angel of the Host should not be traded for trivial Province Defence merely because it flies.

Marignon Pretender families

Family	What it solves	What it must not conceal
Scales and path bridge	Economy, missing Nature/Death/Water/Blood/Glamour, high Astral or Air	A dormant or imprisoned bridge does not help an early war

Family	What it solves	What it must not conceal
Moderate sacred bless	Knights and Flagellants without sacrificing the whole economy	The two sacred types have different bodies and failure modes
Awake expander	Early tempo and difficult neutral provinces	Marignon already has expansion tools; the god must repay its opportunity cost
Angel and endgame enabler	S5-S7, stronger Air, globals, and ritual economy	Researching the ritual is not the same as owning pearls and a safe caster

A durable, resistance-aware bless generally serves sacred cavalry more reliably than a narrow damage gimmick. Flagellants may value different effects because their main problem is surviving contact. The final design should test both bodies separately, including the sacred mounts.

Marignon matchup and failure matrix

Enemy problem	First answer to examine	Avoid
Heavy armour	Crossbows, great weapons, Holy Pyre, armour reduction	Buying only more sword infantry
Fire resistance	Astral control, mundane armour pressure, angels, imported paths	Assuming F3-F4 automatically converts into damage
Mass undead	Priests, H3 support, morale-safe formations, Fire where applicable	Sending expensive priests forward without screens
Flyers and assassins	Patrollers, bodyguards, dispersed command, protected mages	One exposed communion master holding the entire plan
Armour destruction or fatigue	Wider spacing, ranged pressure, quicker battles, alternate troops	Treating protection as permanent
High Magic Resistance	Physical and Fire pressure, buffs, summons	Overcommitting to resistible single-target control

Monthly Marignon audit

- Which capital asset is the current bottleneck?
- Is the next fort followed immediately by a laboratory and Witch Hunter queue?
- Are Grand Master randoms recorded?
- Can the first-war spell be cast by a repeatable mage?
- Does the army have a non-Fire answer?
- Are priests changing dominion where the army will actually fight?
- Are Knights of the Chalice earning more than their fort and resource cost?
- Is Conjuraton research attached to an affordable pearl budget?
- Which missing path is being solved by the Pretender, a summon, or an import?

Marignon verification ledger

Open work remains narrow:

- 1 expansion ranges for each common independent class;
- 2 current live confirmation of the 6.35 Grand Master random display;
- 3 Holy Pyre targeting and friendly-fire formations across battlefield sizes;
- 4 small-communion fatigue budgets using Witch Hunters and Grand Masters;
- 5 angel package survival, upkeep, and return on pearl cost;
- 6 Architect timing versus repeated Grand Master recruitment;

- 7 DE and Divinitus changes kept in separate ruleset appendices.

Dossier source register

Official

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: MA Marignon and MA Pyrène nation pages, national spells and rituals, research, communions, Blood, Inquisition, mounts, and fort construction.
- Illwinter official patch history through 6.36, including the current Send Aatxe restriction and communion corrections.

Structured snapshot

- Dominions 6 Data Inspector, commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc, pinned to the 6.35 data update; used for mage random masks and current object cross-checks.

Interpretation boundary

Roster entries, path masks, costs, and national ritual requirements are source facts. Openings, research trees, Pretender families, battlefield packages, and matchup advice are strategy. Expansion counts, random-result timing, Blood returns, and crossbreeding outputs remain test questions until a versioned raw set is published.